

enough hands-on experience when they leave college.

Apart from providing technical knowledge, Schneider will be setting up a modern lab with state-of-the-art electrical and electronic equipment and associated software, covering industrial automation, control systems and power monitoring. These Schneider-manufactured equipment will be given free of cost to MSRIIT. The institute on its part will provide the infrastructure and other associated equipment to set up the Schneider Centre of Excellence at its campus.

STMicro and Dish TV partner for next-gen set-top box

STMicroelectronics will provide highly integrated system-on-chip (SoC) STB decoder ICs—STi5189 and STi7111—to power Dish TV's latest digital set-top boxes.

Francois Guibert, executive vice president and president for Greater China and South Asia, STMicroelectronics, said, "It is exciting to be working with a partner who owns a platform of 250 channels serving over 7.5 million subscribers and growing." Dish TV has a huge network of over 900 distributors and 48,000 dealers spanning 6600 cities across India.

Jawahar Goel, managing director, Dish TV, said, "We have used STMicroelectronics' platform earlier, and we look forward to using their solutions for standard-definition (SD) as well as high-definition (HD) STBs. Our new digital set-top boxes will deliver innovative value-added services in the coming months."

IBM and IIT Bombay to develop designs for mobile device interface

IBM is teaming up with IIT Bombay to develop new designs for mobile device interfaces that can be easily used by people who are semi-literate or illiterate, as well as individuals who have limited or no access to information technology. As part of the collabora-

SNIPPETS

Samsung to double smartphone market share

Samsung Electronics is planning to increase its market share to 20 per cent in the smartphone category, up from the present 10 per cent, by the year-end. The company has also rolled out its latest Android-powered smartphones—Galaxy 3 and Galaxy 5—in the Indian market. The company would launch 44-45 new handsets in the current year, of which around ten would be in the smartphones category.

Kerala to upgrade classrooms with tech tools

As part of Kerala's model information and communications technology school programme, one selected school in all its 140 assembly constituencies will upgrade five classrooms each with latest tools like multimedia projectors and laptops. "After the schools are selected, specific meetings by the concerned authorities would be held at district and school levels to implement the programmes," said K. Anwar Sadath, executive director, IT@School.

Sharp forms joint venture with Enel and STMicro

Sharp Corp., the world's third-largest solar cell producer, has formed a joint venture with Italian utility Enel and STMicroelectronics NV to make solar cells in Italy for sale in Europe and the Mediterranean area. The production would begin in the second half of 2011 at an existing facility in Catania belonging to STMicro. The project, initially slated to start production in early 2011, had got delayed due to financial reasons.

tion, IBM announced an Open Collaboration Research (OCR) project with the Industrial Design Centre (IDC) at IIT Bombay.

The collaboration aims to introduce new levels of ease-of-use to mobile phone interaction via developed software technology that will be made available to the public through open source.

IIT Bombay selected for HP innovation programme

Indian Institute of Technology Bombay (IIT Bombay) has been selected to participate in the prestigious HP Labs Innovation Research Programme. The programme provides colleges, universities and research institutes around the world with opportunities to conduct breakthrough collaborative research with HP.

Associate professor Soumen Chakrabarti from IIT Bombay will collaborate with HP Labs on a research initiative focused on 'semantic linkage between the Web, intranet and wikipedia: discovery and exploitation in search and aggregation.' The work is being conducted in the Department of

Computer Science and Engineering, IIT Bombay.

The project explores how connections between diverse sets of information can be made using semantic (meaning-based) relationships.

Seagate and Samsung to create SSD controller

Seagate Technology and Samsung Electronics will jointly develop and cross-licence related controller technologies for solidstate drive (SSD) storage devices. The joint development effort builds on the existing SSD capabilities of each company while combining Seagate's expertise in enterprise storage technology with Samsung's flash memory technology specific to 30nm-class multi-level cell NAND. The jointly developed controller will be utilised in Seagate's enterprise-class SSDs.

Steve Luczo, chairman, president and CEO, Seagate, said, "This agreement with Samsung strengthens our SSD solutions strategy, and positions Seagate well as global demand for storage continues on its strong growth path."

Check etetimes.com for more news, daily